The German Pavilion at the Giardini della Biennale in Venice is to be temporarily relocated for the duration of the Biennale d'Arte 2022 and returned to its original location at the end of the exhibition.

Buildings much larger than the German Pavilion have been relocated many times in history, as the following examples show:



Figure 1. Cape Hatteras Lighthouse relocation

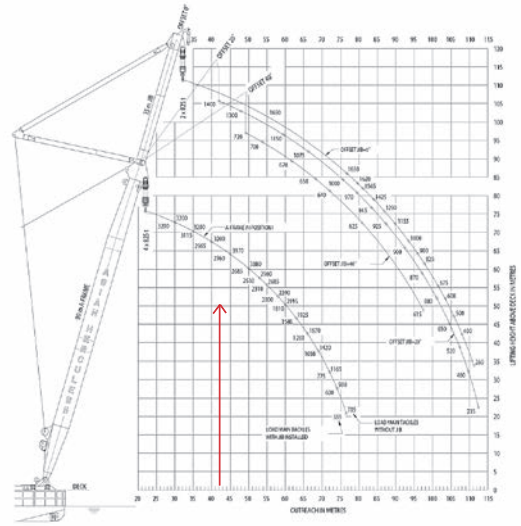


Figure 2. Relocation of Bellview-Biltmore Hotel, Belleair, Florida

This kind of relocation has never been done in Venice. In the case of the German Pavilion, the building lies on a hill over 5 meters above mean sea level.



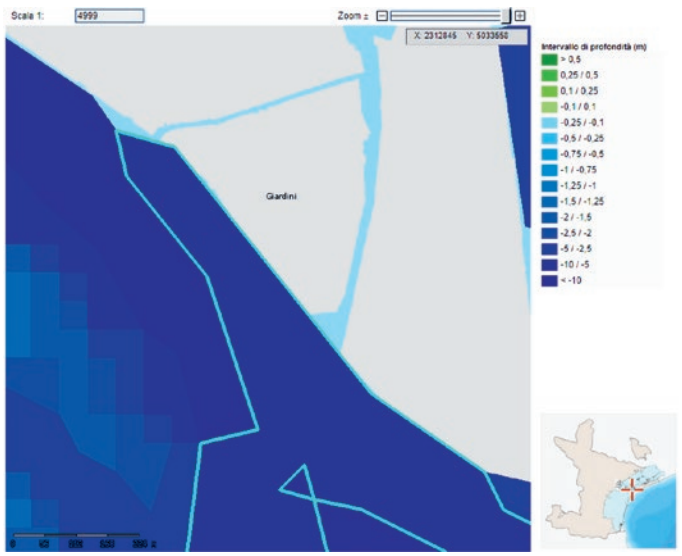




CAPACITY DIAGRAM

LA BIENNALE - GERMAN PAVILLION Preliminary extimation of the lift load					
Element	**A**	**h**	**V**	**γ**	**P**
[-]	[sqm]	[m]	[m³]	[kN/cm]	[kN]
Walls	52	11.4	592.8	18	10670.4
Columns	3.61	11.4	41.154	18	740.772
Slabs	559	0.22	122.98	25	3074.5
TOTAL					**14485.67**

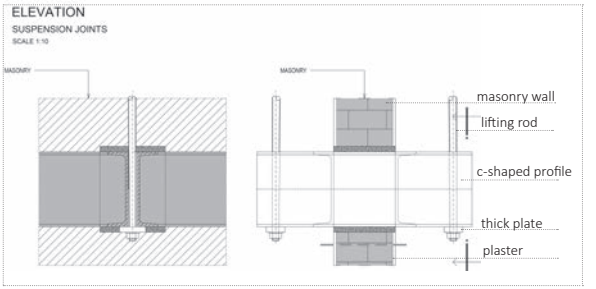




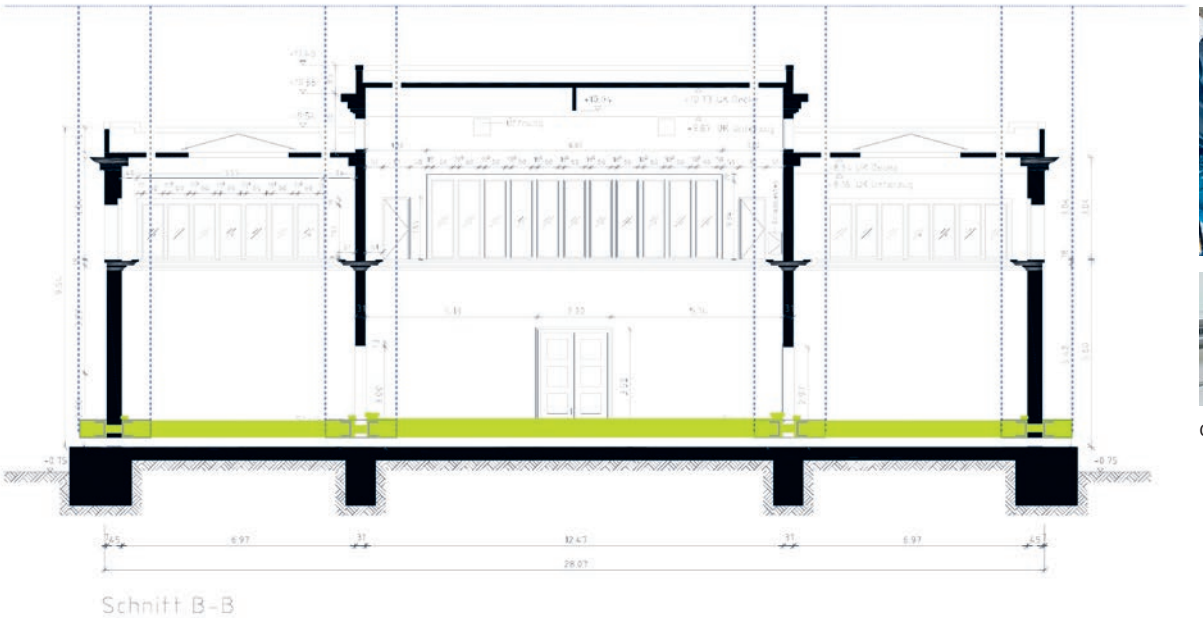
The distance from the pavilion's center to the crane's position has been calculated at 55 m, and the water in front of the building is between 5 m and 10 m deep.

2. Small holes are drilled into the roof for the lifting rods.

3. The walls of the pavilion are cut above its foundations.



Lifting lines



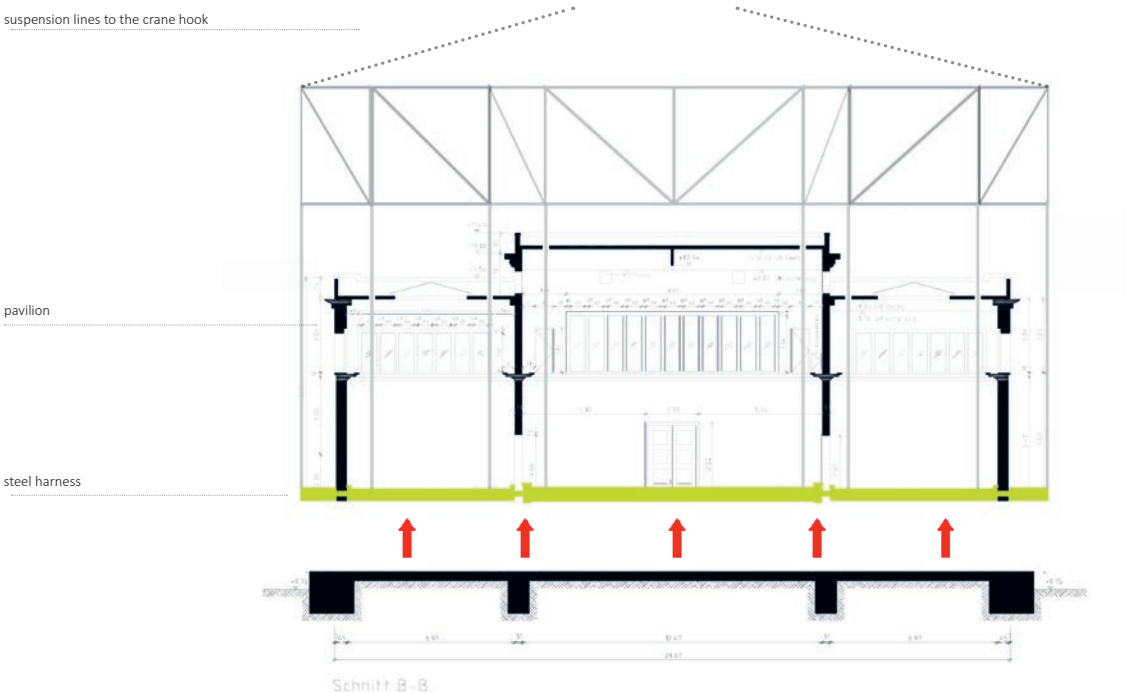




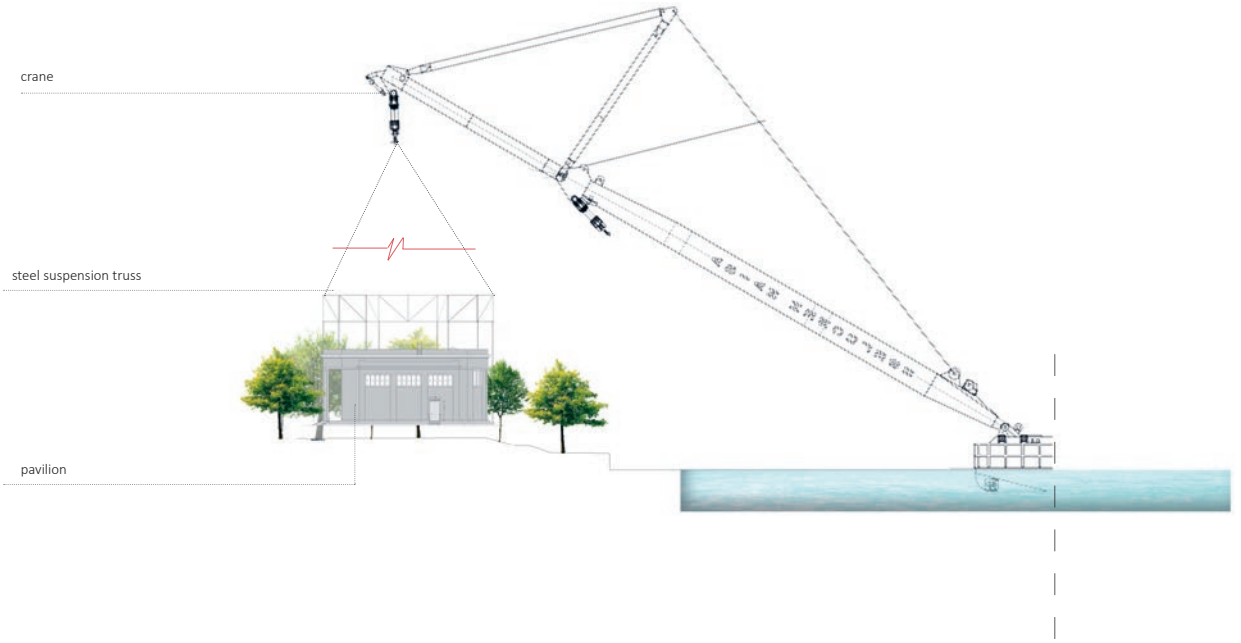
Circular saw method

4. A steel truss for the suspension of the pavilion is constructed.

5. A heavy-lift crane vessel is moored, and the steel truss is positioned above the building.

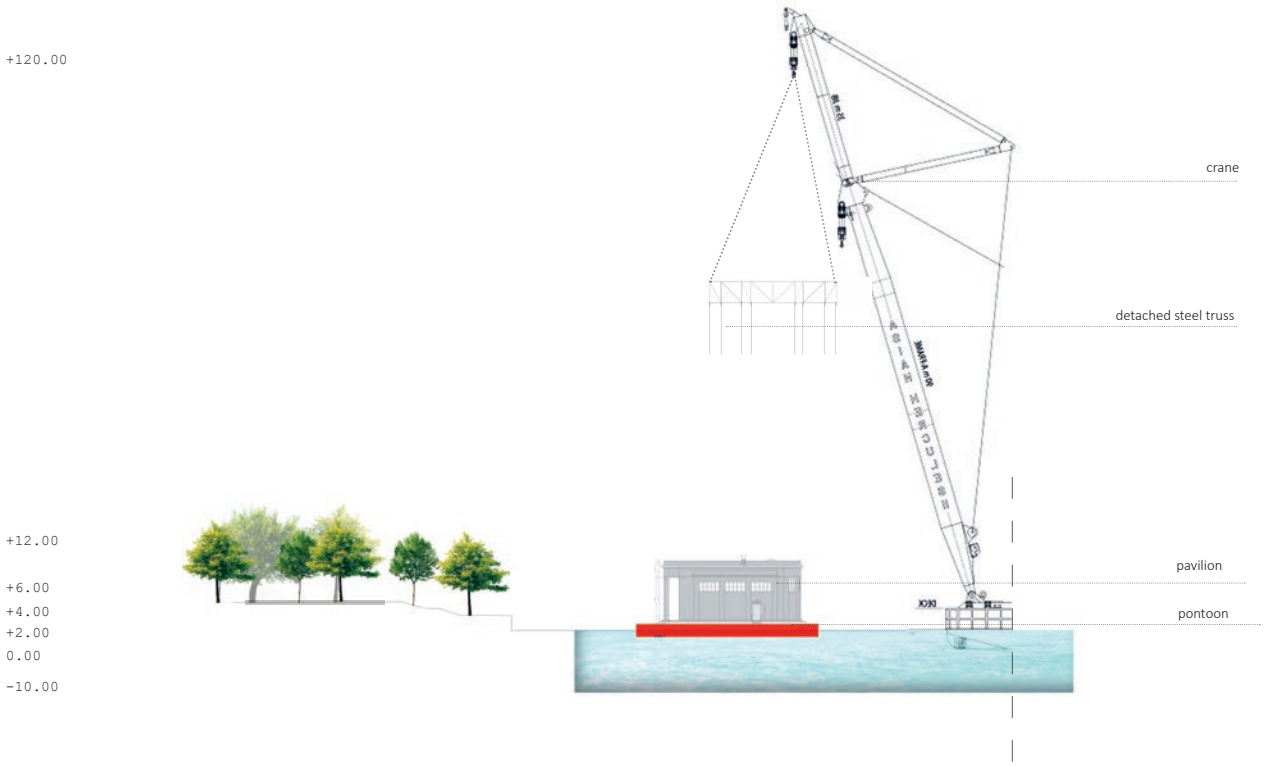


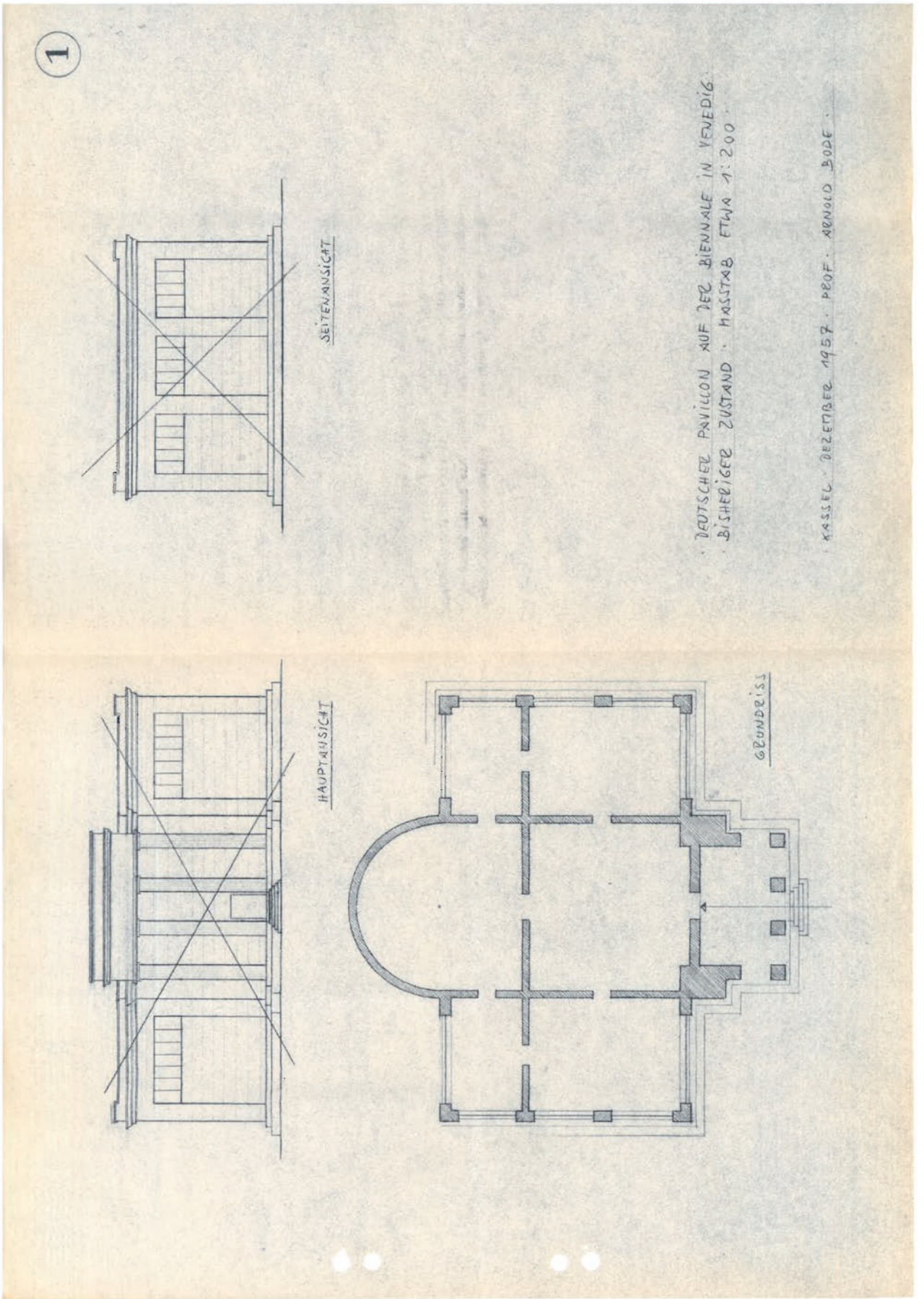
6. The suspension truss is connected to the pavilion's steel harness with rods.



7. The pavilion is lifted and positioned on the pontoon.

8. The pavilion is relocated to the storage area.





Preliminary plans for a redesign of the German Pavilion by Arnold Bode, December 1957 / January 1958

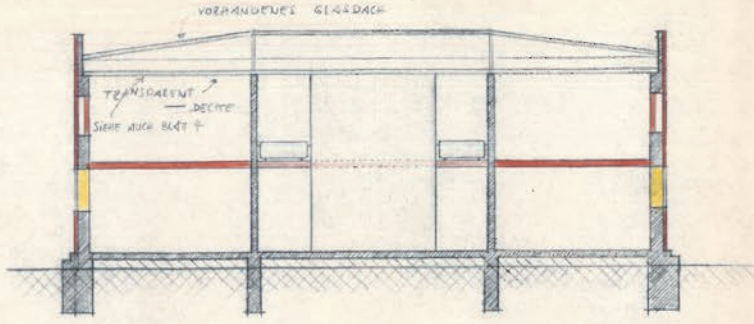
Vorläufige Pläne für einen Umbau des Deutschen Pavillons von Arnold Bode, Dezember 1957 / Januar 1958

Progetti preliminari per una conversione del Padiglione Germania di Arnold Bode, dicembre 1957 / gennaio 1958

2

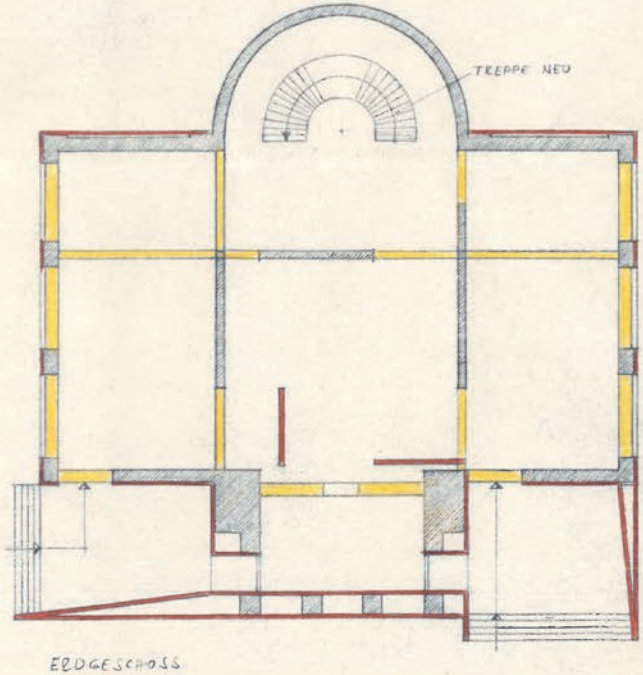
· DEUTSCHER PAVILLON AUF DER BIENNALE IN VENEDIG ·
· IDEEN - VORENTWURF ZUR NEUGESTALTUNG ·
· UNGEFÄHRER MASSSTAB 1:200 ·

· KASSEL · DEZEMBER 1957 · PROF ARNOLD BODE ·

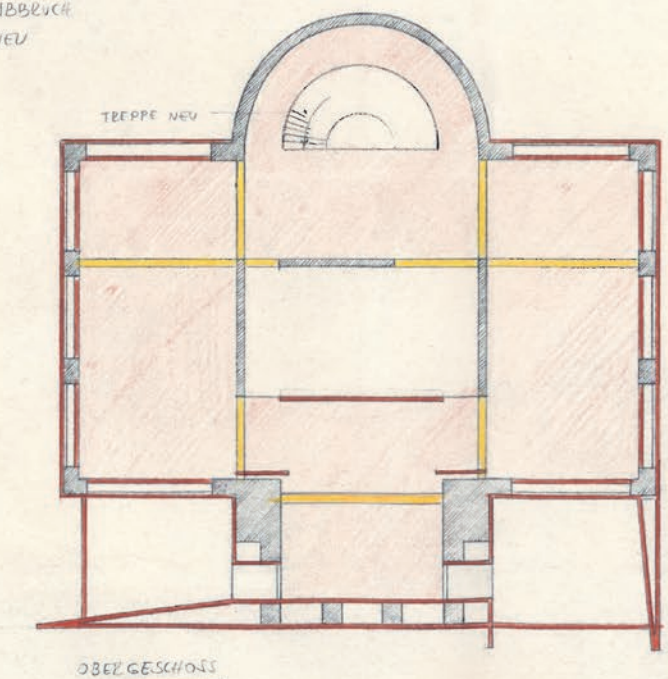


SCHNITT

ALT
ABBRUCH
NEU

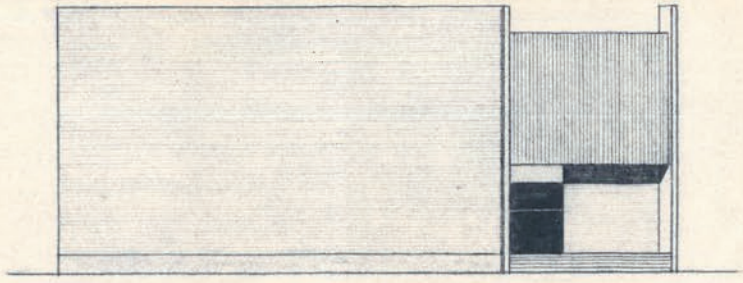


ERDGESCHOSS

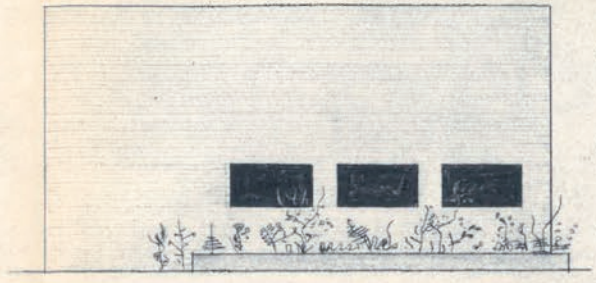


OBERGESCHOSS

2 (3)



NEUE HAUPTANSICHT



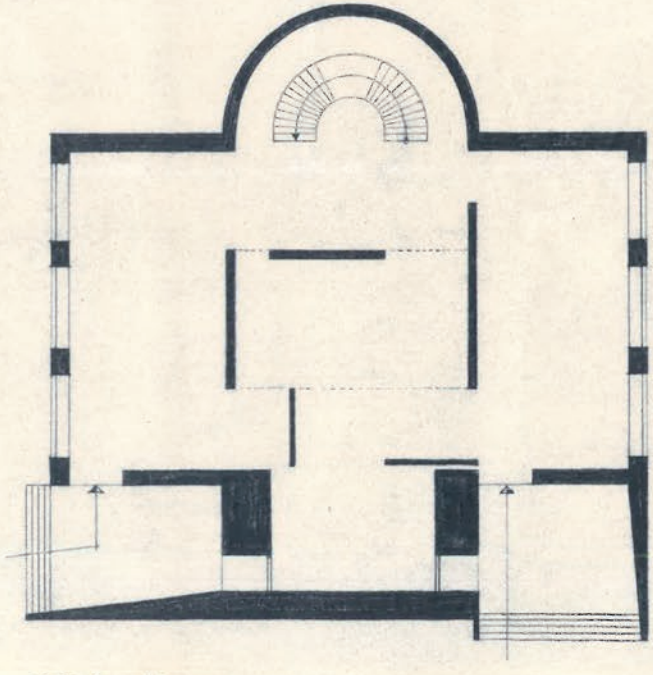
NEUE SEITENANSICHT

· DEUTSCHER PAVILLON
AUF DER BIENNALE IN VENEDIG ·

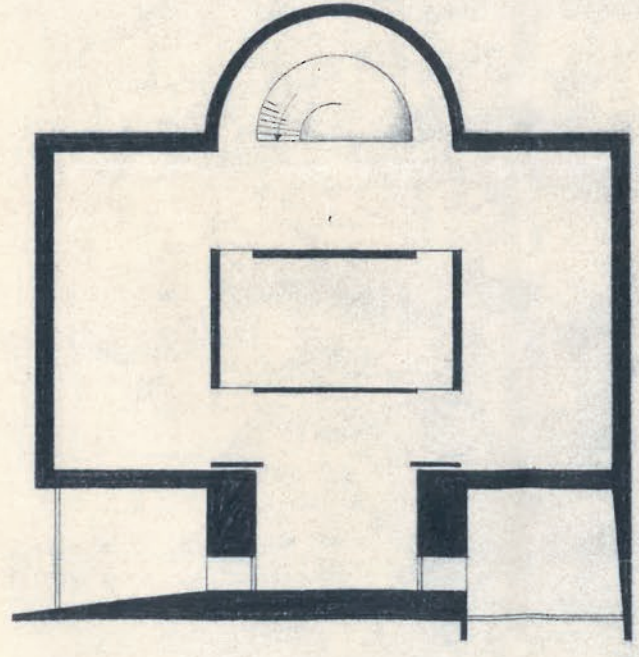
· IDEEN-VORENTWURF ZUR
NEUGESTALTUNG ·

· UNGEFÄHRER MASSTAB 1:200 ·

· KASSEL · DEZEMBER 1957 ·
· PROF. ARNOLD BODE ·

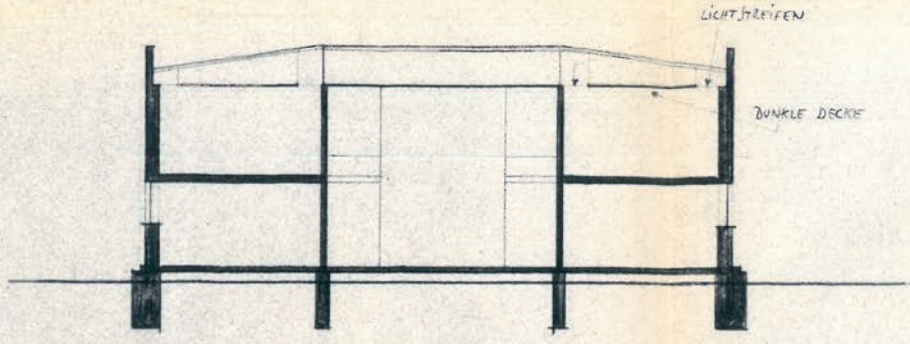


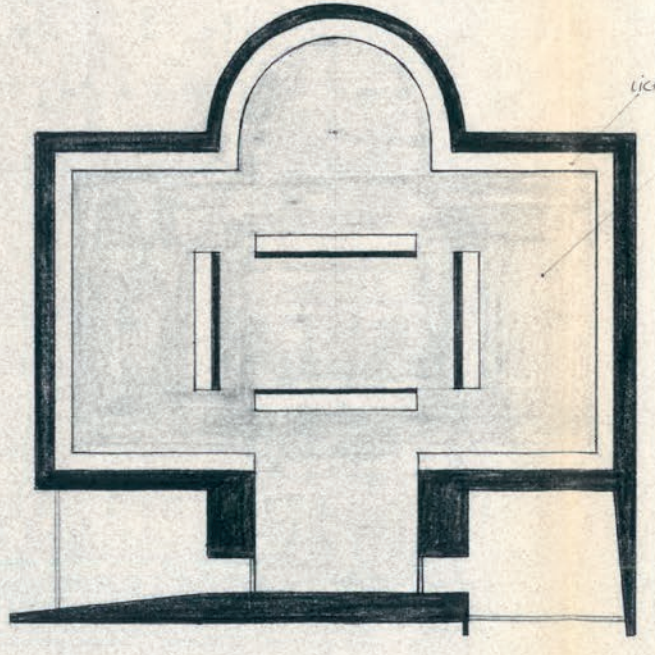
ERDGESCHOSS



OBERGESCHOSS

4



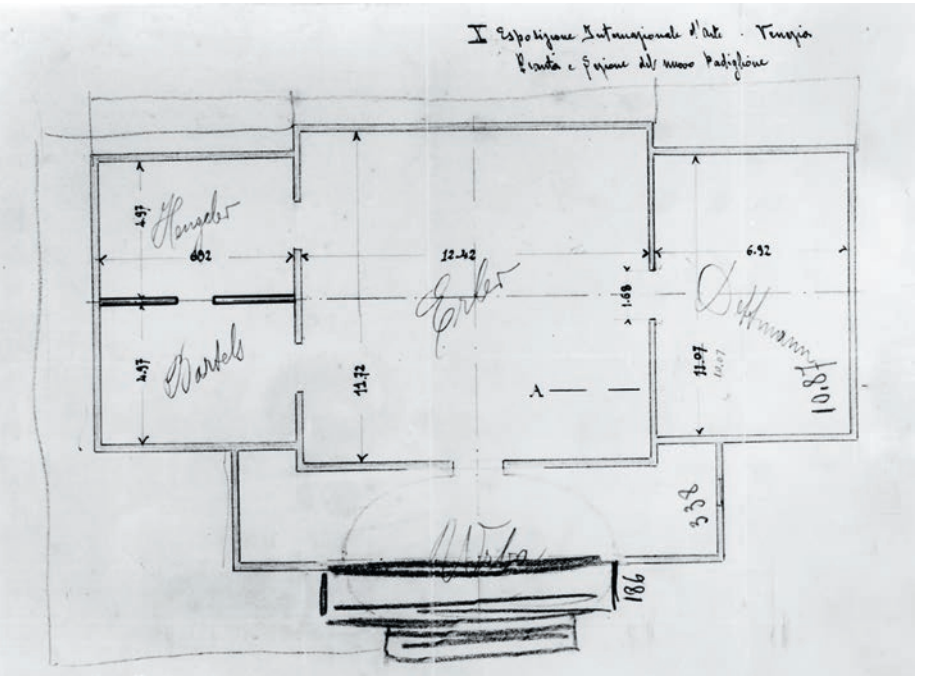


- DEUTSCHER PAVILLON AUF DER BIENNALE IN VENEDIG.
- IDEEN-VORENTWURF ZUR NEUGESTALTUNG.
- NEUE DECKE ÜBER DEM 1. STOCK.
- UNGEFÄHRER MASSTAB 1:200.

- KASSEL · JANUAR 1958 · PROF. ARNOLD BODE.



Exterior view, 1912
The German Pavilion with its new frescoes



Floor plan sketch, 1912
The earliest dated floor plan shows the side rooms of the building formally aligned with the center of the main space. The portico, which is incorrectly depicted here, has been added as a separate construction.

Außenansicht, 1912
Der mit Fresken versehene Deutsche Pavillon

Grundrissskizze, 1912
Der älteste datierte Grundriss zeigt den Hauptraum, an den rechts und links mittig die Nebenräume angesetzt sind. Die hier nicht korrekt dargestellte Vorhalle ist wie ein separates Bauteil hinzugestellt.

Vista esterna, 1912
Il Padiglione Germania con gli affreschi

Schizzo di pianta dell'edificio, 1912
La piantina con la data più antica mostra la sala principale con a destra e a sinistra due sale laterali centrate rispetto alla sala centrale. Il portico, che qui non è disegnato correttamente, è aggiunto come fosse un corpo edificale separato.



Exterior view, 1920s
The frescoes had already been removed in the 1920s.

The building's interior remained unchanged up until the 1926 Biennale, as seen in this photograph from the same year.

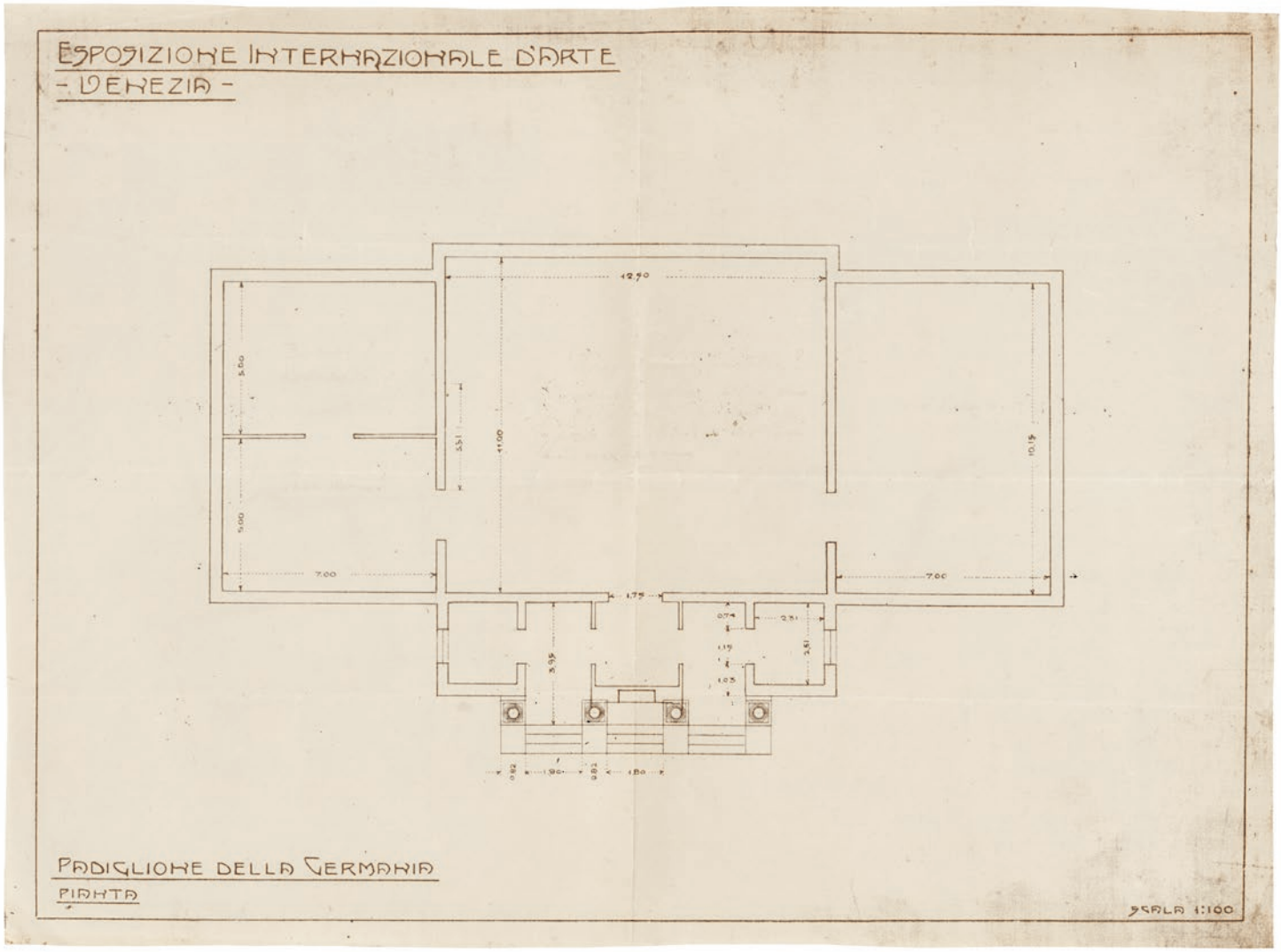


Außenansicht, 1920er Jahre
In den 1920er Jahren sind die Fresken bereits entfernt.

Das Innere des Gebäudes bleibt bis zur Biennale 1926 unverändert, wie die Aufnahme aus diesem Jahr belegt.

Vista esterna, anni venti
Negli anni venti gli affreschi sono già stati eliminati.

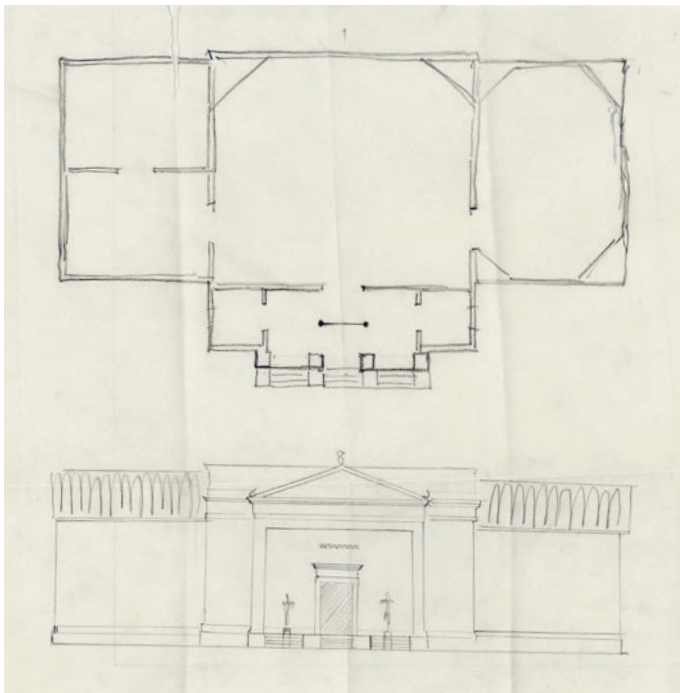
L'interno dell'edificio rimane inalterato fino alla Biennale del 1926, come dimostra la fotografia scattata lo stesso anno.



Floor plan of the German Pavilion, probably from 1928

Grundriss des Deutschen Pavillons, vermutlich von 1928

Planimetria del Padiglione Germania, probabilmente del 1928



This hand-drawn sketch, possibly by Friedrich Dörnhöffer, shows the original intention behind the conversion: as well as moving the interior doorways, a vestibule was to be built inside the portico and enclosed to give it a more unified appearance.

Diese möglicherweise von Friedrich Dörnhöffer stammende Handskizze zeigt die ursprüngliche Intention des Umbaus: Neben der Versetzung der Durchgänge im Innenraum soll nicht nur ein Windfang in den Portikus eingebaut, sondern dieser auch geschlossen werden, was ihm ein einheitlicheres Erscheinungsbild verleihen würde.

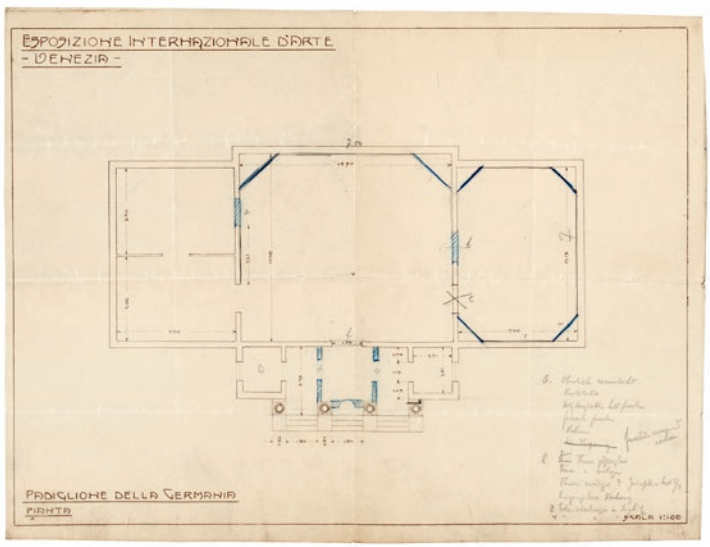
Questo schizzo disegnato a mano, probabilmente eseguito da Friedrich Dörnhöffer, mostra qual era l'intenzione originaria del rifacimento: oltre allo spostamento dei vani delle porte nello spazio interno, non solo si sarebbe costruita una bussola nel portico, ma quest'ultimo abrebbe anche dovuto essere chiuso per conferirgli un aspetto più unitario.



Exterior view, portico, 1930s

Außenansicht, Vorhalle, 1930er Jahre

Vista esterna, vestibolo, anni trenta



Floor plan sketch, probably from 1928
The actual alterations, however, left the portico columns visible. In the building measurements, evidently made in preparation for the alterations, the front wall of the main space has mistakenly been aligned flush with the front walls of the side rooms. The sketch shows, like the floor plan from 1912, the correct, stepped alignment.

Grundrissskizze, vermutlich von 1928
Bei dem schließlich erfolgten Umbau werden die Säulen des Portikus allerdings sichtbar belassen. Bei dem im Zusammenhang dieser Maßnahmen offenkundig neu angefertigten Aufmaß des Pavillons wird die vordere Wand des Hauptraums fehlerhaft auf eine Flucht mit den Wänden der Nebenräume gesetzt. Die Handskizze zeigt, wie auch der Grundriss von 1912, noch den richtigen, versetzten Zustand.

Schizzo di pianta dell'edificio, probabilmente del 1928
Nel rifacimento poi effettivamente realizzato le colonne del portico vengono comunque lasciate visibili. Nella nuova misurazione del Padiglione, effettuata nel contesto di questi interventi, la parete anteriore della sala principale è erroneamente allineata con le pareti delle sale laterali. Lo schizzo disegnato a mano e anche la pianta del 1912 mostrano ancora la situazione con le pareti delle ali laterali correttamente arretrate.